

“Our struggle has reached a decisive stage.
Our march to freedom is irreversible.”

NELSON MANDELA ON HIS RELEASE FROM PRISON, 1990



2 February 1990

SOUTH AFRICAN GOVERNMENT ANNOUNCES AN END TO APARTHEID

After years of international pressure, South Africa's new president, F. W. de Klerk, announced an end to discriminatory laws and to the ban on the African National Congress (ANC) and other groups fighting apartheid. Nine days later, the leading anti-apartheid campaigner and ANC leader Nelson Mandela, who had been imprisoned for 27 years, was released from jail. Negotiations between the government and the ANC began that led to the nation's first universal-suffrage general election four years later.

◀ Nelson Mandela

4 October 1991 The
Madrid Protocol on
the preservation of
Antarctica is agreed

1990

1 October 1990 The **Human Genome Project** to read the entire human DNA code sequence is launched

3 October 1990
Germany is reunified after 45 years of division

3 November 1992
Bill Clinton is elected 42nd President of the United States



△ Iraqi soldiers confident of victory

2 August 1990

IRAQ'S INVASION OF KUWAIT TRIGGERS THE GULF WAR

In a dispute over oil production, Iraq's leader Saddam Hussein ordered his troops to invade neighbouring Kuwait. US President George H. W. Bush set about organizing a multinational force to liberate the country. Eventually 35 nations joined this "coalition of the willing", with most troops coming from the US, Saudi Arabia, the UK, and Egypt. After six weeks' fighting early in 1991, Kuwait's independence was restored.